BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

US Communications Infrastructure

## CoreWeave, Inc.

Rating

**Underperform**

Price Target

**CRWV** **74.00 USD**




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# Coreweave (CRWV): Debt-maxxing... growth at literally any price?

CoreWeave fell roughly 15% Wednesday as investors reconsidered not the demand for its capacity, but the cost of funding it. Its unsecured bond yields have approached 15%—levels typically associated with distress. That does not reset the interest bill on existing fixed-rate debt overnight, but it does raise the question: what will the next dollar of growth cost?

This has long been a concern of ours. CoreWeave is a wildly capital-intensive business without a separate cash-generating engine to help foot the bill. The GPUs are spendy, the cash goes out well before the customer payments come in, and rapid growth compounds the funding gap. In Q2, CoreWeave generated $679M of operating cash flow against $9.4B of adj. capex. Net interest expense was $640M—roughly a quarter of revenue. The company remains heavily reliant on external financing to fund its build-out.

Several concerns are converging. First, the market is demanding substantially more compensation to own CoreWeave's unsecured credit: its 2032 bond now yields approximately 14.8%, versus a 9.625% coupon. Second, the contracts underpinning future borrowing matter. To the extent growth shifts toward shorter contracts and non-investment-grade customers, lenders have less contractual protection—and will demand more compensation. Finally, the obligations themselves are substantial: at June-end, CoreWeave had approximately $35B of debt, plus another $16.5B of lease liabilities. More financing can enable more growth, but it also adds more claims ahead of the equity.

We concede that the core funding dependence did not emerge today. There is plenty of momentum and narrative at work. But a near -15% bond yield is a hard number to ignore, and today's report that CoreWeave is courting insurers' capital put the funding question front and center - the search for more, cheaper capital is an increasingly visible part of the investment case. Gartner published a report reiterating many of our longstanding concerns about the neocloud model. Then Elon tweeted "yikes," which rarely improves anyone's afternoon.

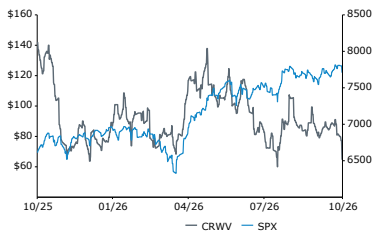
Today was less about a new operating disclosure than a sharper repricing of an existing financing risk. The backlog can be real and the equity economics can still be fragile. CoreWeave does not just need customers willing to buy the compute. It needs lenders willing to fund the hardware on terms that leave something attractive for shareholders. **In our view, the company's long-term business model remains economically challenged; we maintain our Underperform.**

| | |
|---|---|
| Close Date | 14 Oct 2026 |
| CRWV Close Price (USD) | 65.78 |
| Price Target (USD) | 74.00 |
| Upside/(Downside) | 12% |
| 52-Week Range | 150.40/60.55 |
| SPX | 7,718.94 |
| FYE | Dec |
| Div Yield | NA |
| Market Cap (USD) (M) | 36,762 |
| EV (USD) (M) | 82,831 |

| Performance | YTD | 1M | 6M | 12M |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Absolute (%) | (8.1) | (20.7) | (43.9) | (50.9) |
| SPX (%) | 12.8 | 1.3 | 10.8 | 16.2 |
| Relative (%) | (20.9) | (22.0) | (54.7) | (67.1) |

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR




| Adjusted EPS | F25A | F26E | F27E |
|---|---|---|---|
| CRWV (USD) | (1.20) | (4.56) | (4.77) |

| Financials | F25A | F26E | F27E | CAGR |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Revenues (M) | 5,131 | 12,622 | 23,552 | 114.2% |
| EBITDA (M) | 2,442 | 6,826 | 14,974 | 147.6% |

| Valuation Metrics | 25A | 26E | 27E |
|---|---|---|---|
| EV/EBIT (x) | N/M | 264 | 33.4 |
| Adjusted P/E (x) | (54.9) | (14.4) | (13.8) |

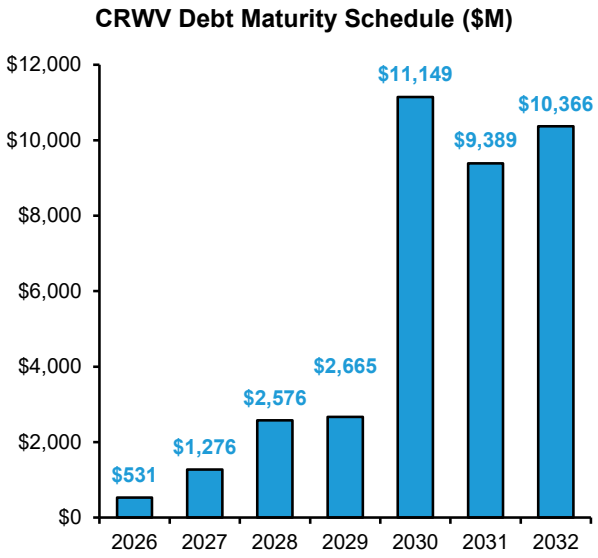
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 1: **CRWV Debt Overview**

| Debt Description | Outstanding[1] ($M) | Total Capacity | Eff. Interest Rate (%) | Rate Type | Issue Date | Maturity Date | Int. Exp |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| DDTL 1.0 | $1,300 | $2,300 | 15% | Variable | Jul-23 | Mar-28 | $195 |
| OEM and Software License Financing | $5,102 | $5,200 | 11% | Fixed | Various | Various[2] | $544 |
| Magnetar Loan | $189 | $189 | 12% | Fixed | Aug-24 | Jan-29 | $23 |
| Revolving Credit Facility | $1,200 | $2,500 | 7% | Variable | May-25 | Nov-29 | $84 |
| 2030 Senior Notes | $2,000 | $2,000 | 10% | Fixed | May-25 | Jun-30 | $200 |
| DDTL 2.0 | $3,190 | $7,600 | 11% | Variable | May-24 | Aug-30 | $351 |
| DDTL 3.0 | $2,215 | $2,600 | 9% | Variable | Jul-25 | Aug-30 | $199 |
| DDTL 2.1 | $3,000 | $3,000 | 9% | Variable | Sep-25 | Dec-30 | $270 |
| 2031 9.00% Senior Notes | $1,750 | $1,750 | 10% | Fixed | Apr-26 | Feb-31 | $175 |
| DDTL 5.5 | $1,200 | $2,600 | 9% | Variable | Aug-26 | Sep-31 | $108 |
| 2031 9.75% Senior Notes | $2,750 | $2,750 | 10% | Fixed | Apr-26 | Oct-31 | $275 |
| DDTL 5.0 | $1,101 | $3,100 | 9% | Variable | May-26 | Nov-31 | $99 |
| 2031 Convertible Senior Notes | $2,588 | $2,588 | 2% | Fixed | Dec-25 | Dec-31 | $52 |
| DDTL 4.0 | $2,837 | $8,500 | 7% | Variable | Mar-26 | Mar-32 | $199 |
| 2032 9.625% Senior Notes | $1,250 | $1,250 | 10% | Fixed | Jun-26 | Jul-32 | $125 |
| 2032 EUR Senior Notes | $2,279 | $2,279 | 9% | Fixed | Jun-26 | Jul-32 | $205 |
| 2032 Convertible Senior Notes | $4,000 | $4,000 | 2% | Fixed | Apr-26 | Oct-32 | $80 |
| 2033 Convertible Notes | $3,000 | $3,000 | 3% | Fixed | Sep-26 | Apr-33 | $79 |
| **Total** | **$40,951** | **$57,206** | **8.0%** | | | | **$3,262** |

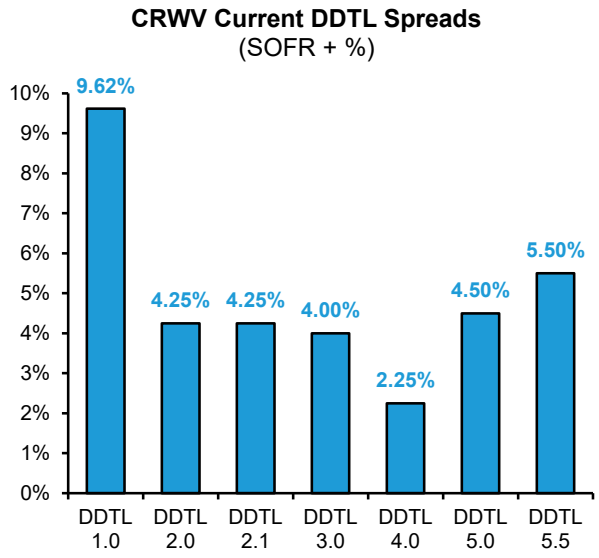
Source: Company filings, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 2: **CRWV Debt Maturity Schedule**




Source: Company filings, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 3: **CRWV Current DDTL Spreads**




Source: Company filings, Bernstein analysis

## INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We are Underperform on CRWV with a price target of $74. We continue to believe that CRWV will sign more deals. The stock may perform well in the near-term on the momentum of those signings; however, on a long-term, fundamental basis, we have concerns about the business model and CRWV's role in the infrastructure ecosystem.

Our case hinges on our longer-term revenue expectations for CRWV, which are significantly lower than street expectations. In general, we question CRWV's ability to continue to sign large-scale hyperscale deals as data center supply becomes more readily available (2028+) and are concerned that hyperscalers are likely to attempt head-on competition with neoclouds for enterprise business.

We disagree with CRWV's premise that its existing software moat will hold up to hyperscaler attacks, especially given hyperscalers' scale and ability to spend. We do not believe the structural concerns abate with increased AI demand, though the timing for our call may be pushed further out.

## BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

| | | | 14 Oct 2026 | | TTM | | Adjusted EPS | | | EV/EBIT (x) | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Closing | Price | Rel. | | | | | | | |
| Ticker | Rating | Cur | Price | Target | Perf. | Cur | 2025A | 2026E | 2027E | 2025A | 2026E | 2027E |
| CRWV (CoreWeave) | U | USD | 65.78 | 74.00 | (67.1)% | USD | (1.20) | (4.56) | (4.77) | N/M | 264 | 33.4 |
| SPX | | | 7,718.94 | | | | | | | | | |

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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**CoreWeave, Inc.**

We value CRWV on a forward EV/Adjusted EBIT multiple. Our $74 price target is based on an Enterprise Value calculated as 25.5x NTM+1 Adj. Operating Income of $5.2B.

### RISKS

**CoreWeave, Inc.**

The main upside risks to our price target/Underperform rating on CRWV are 1) Delays in hyperscaler built capacity coming online may maintain CRWV value proposition, 2) Development of CRWV’s specialized software platform which maintains demand for CRWV operated data centers, and 3) Continued shortage in power supply to power data centers may sustain CRWV’s pricing power

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The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

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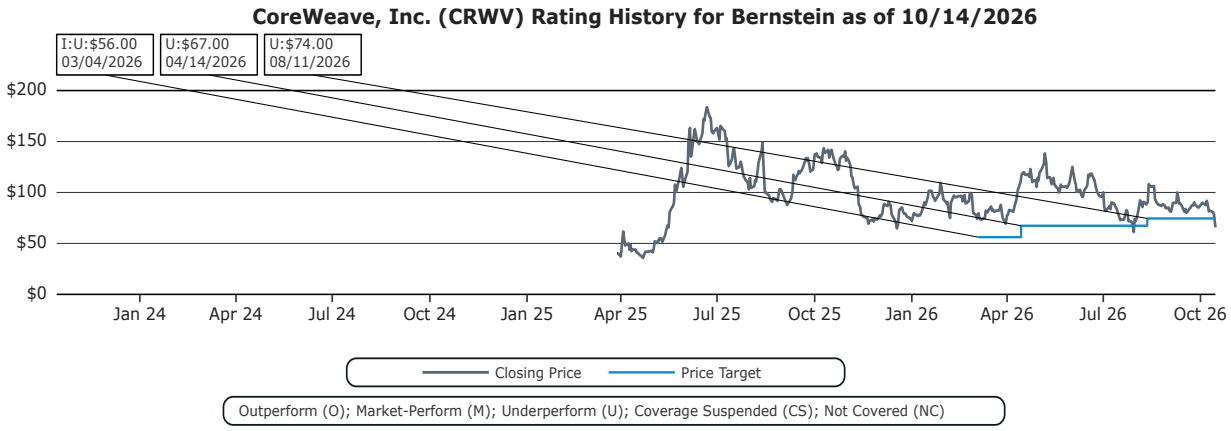
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|---|---|---|---|
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| Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand)<br>Neutral (Autonomous Brand) | HOLD | 35.6% | 16.1% |
| Underperform | SELL | 12.1% | 13.6% |

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
As of September 30, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

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